

By **SIDDHARTH ROY KAPUR,** *Founder & MD, Roy Kapur Films*

LIGHTS, CAMERA, INDIA

INDIA'S MEDIA AND ENTERTAINMENT INDUSTRY IS GOING THROUGH A MULTI-LAYERED TRANSFORMATION, WITH A LOT HAPPENING AT ONCE. THE DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND WILL ALLOW GROWTH ACROSS ALL PLATFORMS

It's never easy to be asked to prognosticate about the media and entertainment industry, because in even relatively stable times, your best predictions can go wildly wrong. It feels even more of a fool's errand to do so as I pen this article in January 2023, given the disruption that the COVID-19 pandemic has caused in audience behaviour across the world, precipitating a 180-degree whiplash in strategies and tactics at most studios, streamers, exhibitors, broadcasters and creators. But why are we even in this deliciously volatile industry if we don't stick our necks out every now and then? And so, much against my saner judgement, I shall.

It is now clear that the reports about the imminent demise of the theatrical experience have been greatly exaggerated. Audiences have come out in droves for titles released in 2022, such as *Avatar: The Way of Water*, *Top Gun: Maverick* and *Jurassic World Dominion* globally, and closer home, for *K.G.F: Chapter 2*, *RRR* and *Drishyam 2*, amongst others. It is clear that we still love and cherish the experience of visiting a darkened cinema hall with a group of strangers and losing ourselves to the magic of the big screen. While this is true, correspondingly what is also increasingly clear is that the kinds of genres that audiences now seek out for the theatrical experience have narrowed down to very specific ones. Superhero movies, visual spectacles, high-adrenaline and high-octane action, creature movies and thrillers are ruling the roost at the